PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

The Digital Literacy Project is designed to develop essential skills required to navigate the modern digital world effectively and responsibly. As a first-year student of Computer Science Engineering with a specialization in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, I take on the role of a *Student Digital Ambassador*. In this role, my objective is to help my peers understand the importance of building a professional online presence, using digital tools efficiently, and maintaining safe and ethical behaviour in online environments.

The project consists of five structured tasks, including creating a digital awareness infographic, developing a professional portfolio on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, exploring coding and collaboration tools, drafting professional emails, and studying cybercrime along with prevention strategies. All these tasks are organized in a GitHub repository and documented in a detailed project report.

This project will help me strengthen my technical, communication, and digital awareness skills, which are essential for my academic growth and future career in the field of AI and Machine Learning.

TASK-1

For designing my Digital Literacy Awareness infographic, I used Canva, a user-friendly online design platform that provides a wide range of templates, icons, and customization options. It allowed me to create a clean, visually engaging, and well-organized infographic without needing advanced design skills.

My infographic is titled *"Digital Literacy Essentials"* and is divided into three main sections. The first section explains what digital literacy is, defining it as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technology. The second section highlights useful digital tools for students, such as Google Docs for collaboration, Trello, and Zoom for video meeting. The final section focuses on safe internet practices, where I included important tips like using strong passwords, Verify sources, and protecting personal information online. The use of icons, simple language, and structured layout makes the information easy to understand and visually appealing.

One interesting aspect I found while creating this infographic was how visual elements like colours and illustrations can make learning more engaging. However, I found it slightly challenging to maintain a balance between text and design, as too much information could make the infographic look crowded.

TASK-2

For building my digital portfolio, I created accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, as these platforms are essential for students pursuing Computer Science with a specialization in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning. GitHub serves as a platform for version control and project hosting, enabling me to showcase my coding skills, collaborate on projects, and maintain a structured record of my work.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that helps in building an online identity, connecting with industry professionals, and exploring internships and career opportunities. Kaggle is widely used in the data science community for working with real-world datasets, participating in machine learning competitions, and learning advanced analytical techniques.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to regularly upload AI/ML projects, including implementations of algorithms, data analysis tasks, and collaborative work. On LinkedIn, I will focus on building a strong professional profile by sharing my achievements, certifications, and projects while expanding my professional network. Through Kaggle, I aim to enhance my practical knowledge by participating in competitions, experimenting with datasets, and improving my problem-solving and model-building skills. These platforms will significantly contribute to my technical expertise and career readiness in AI and ML.

TASK-3

For this task, I explored both coding practice and collaboration platforms to enhance my technical and academic skills. I used HackerRank as my coding platform, where I completed a beginner-level problem to strengthen my understanding of basic programming concepts and problem-solving techniques. It helped me improve my logical thinking and coding confidence, which are essential for a Computer Science student.

For collaboration, I created a Google Form as a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” consisting of five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer types. This form can be used to assess the digital awareness of my batchmates. I also reviewed the responses through Google Sheets, which helped me understand how data can be collected and analyzed efficiently.

These platforms will be highly beneficial for my academic journey. HackerRank will help me continuously improve my coding skills and prepare for technical interviews. Google Forms and Sheets will assist me in conducting surveys, organizing information, and analyzing data, which are important skills in AI and Machine Learning. Overall, this task enhanced both my technical abilities and my understanding of collaborative digital tools.

TASK-4

A situation where poor digital communication could cause a problem is when a student sends an email to a professor requesting an assignment extension but does not clearly explain the reason or uses an unprofessional tone. For example, if the student simply writes a short message like “I need more time” without proper greeting, subject line, or explanation, the professor may misunderstand the seriousness of the request or may not consider it valid.

In contrast, in my email, I clearly mentioned the reason (health issue), provided the original and requested deadline, and maintained a respectful and professional tone. This helps in building trust and increases the chances of a positive response.

To avoid communication problems, it is important to be polite, provide clear context, and structure the email properly. Using a formal tone, complete information, and proper formatting ensures effective and professional digital communication.

TASK-5

Researching UPI and online payment fraud revealed several startling insights into the sophistication of modern cybercrime. What surprised me most was how fraudsters systematically exploit human psychology rather than just technical loopholes. Instead of complex hacking, they use "social engineering" to build trust, often posing as helpful customer care executives or buyers to create a false sense of security. It is particularly alarming that scammers can trick victims into a "debit" transaction by simply reframing a "collect request" or a QR code scan as a way to "receive" money. The fact that these crimes can drain a bank account in seconds, leaving the victim with severe emotional distress and little hope for recovery, underscores the clinical efficiency of these operations.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my . Previously, I viewed scanning a code as a neutral action; now, I recognize it as a high-risk authorization. I will strictly follow the rule of never entering my UPI PIN or scanning a code unless I am the one initiating a payment to a verified, trusted source. This shift from passive trust to active verification is the most effective way to ensure my financial safety in an increasingly digital economy.

CONCLUSION

The Digital Literacy Project has been a valuable learning experience that enhanced my understanding of essential digital skills required in today's world. Through this project, I learned how to create informative visual content, build a professional online presence, and use various digital platforms effectively. Developing profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle helped me understand the importance of maintaining a strong digital identity for academic and career growth.

I also improved my communication skills by learning proper email etiquette and understanding the impact of professional digital communication. Additionally, researching cybercrime and its prevention increased my awareness of online safety and responsible internet usage.

Overall, this project helped me develop technical, analytical, and communication skills while encouraging responsible digital behavior. It has prepared me to confidently use digital tools and platforms, which will be highly beneficial throughout my academic journey and future career in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning.

REFRENCES

1. Canva – https://www.canva.com/
   Used for designing the Digital Literacy infographic.
2. GitHub – https://github.com/
   Used for creating and managing the project repository and portfolio.
3. LinkedIn – https://www.linkedin.com/
   Used for building a professional online profile and networking.
4. Kaggle – https://www.kaggle.com/
   Used for exploring datasets and learning machine learning concepts.
5. HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com/
   Used for practicing coding problems and improving programming skills.
6. Google Forms – https://forms.google.com/
   Used for creating the Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz.
7. National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in/
   Used for understanding cybercrime reporting and safety measures.
8. Cyber Crime Helpline 1930
   Used as an official helpline for reporting financial cyber fraud in India.